

UPSC INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS WORKBOOK

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy Solved-Practice Workbook

Subject: International Relations | Paper: GS-II
Eight source-trap MCQs with strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation
Original 10-, 15- and 20-mark solved content frameworks



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Topic-Specific MCQ Loop 1

GS-II
International
Relations

INTRO & ORIGIN

Each question is generated from an explicit source-chapter trap and explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Q1. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Panchsheel and non-alignment are the same concept."?

- A. Panchsheel is a set of
- B. Panchsheel and non-alignment are the same concept.
- C. MAHASAGAR replaced or superseded SAGAR.
- D. Hedging means India avoids taking any position.

- ANSWER: A - Panchsheel is a set of

- Q2. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "MAHASAGAR replaced or superseded SAGAR."?

- A. MAHASAGAR replaced or superseded SAGAR.
- B. The 12 March 2025 announcement
- C. Hedging means India avoids taking any position.
- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: B - The 12 March 2025 announcement

- Q3. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Hedging means India avoids taking any position."?

- A. Hedging means India avoids taking any position.
- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.
- C. Hedging means actively
- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: C - Hedging means actively

- Q4. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.
- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.
- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.
- D. ☐ ☐ **Act East / Neighbourhood First**: contemporary policy doctrines that

- ANSWER: D - ☐ ☐ **Act East / Neighbourhood First**: contemporary policy doctrines that

MEMORY HOOK

Resolve the misconception before memorising the fact.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic
Autonomy -> Source-grounded practice

HIGH**Topic-Specific MCQ Loop 2****GS-II**
International
Relations**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Each question is generated from an explicit source-chapter trap and explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Q5. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. ☐ ☐ **Development partnership model:** lines of credit, capacity building and

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: A - ☐ ☐ **Development partnership model:** lines of credit, capacity building and

- Q6. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. ☐ **Voice of Global South Summit:** a contemporary multilateral platform India

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: B - ☐ **Voice of Global South Summit:** a contemporary multilateral platform India

- Q7. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. ☐ Sikri frames the core strategic choice as whether "India want[s] to be

- D. Panchsheel and non-alignment are the same concept.

- ANSWER: C - ☐ Sikri frames the core strategic choice as whether "India want[s] to be

- Q8. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. Panchsheel and non-alignment are the same concept.

- C. MAHASAGAR replaced or superseded SAGAR.

- D. ☐ ☐ India's simultaneous deepening of ties with the US (technology, defence

- ANSWER: D - ☐ ☐ India's simultaneous deepening of ties with the US (technology, defence

MEMORY HOOK

Resolve the misconception before memorising the fact.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic
Autonomy -> Source-grounded practice

HIGH

Solved 10-Mark Practice

GS-II
International
Relations

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

1. Concept

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ **Panchsheel (1954)**: historical normative reference for peaceful
- ☐ **Non-alignment / NAM**: historical institutional expression of the refusal
- ☐ **SAGAR and its stated extension MAHASAGAR**: ☐ SAGAR ("Security and Growth
- ☐ **Act East / Neighbourhood First**: contemporary policy doctrines that
- ☐ **Development partnership model**: lines of credit, capacity building and
- ☐ **Voice of Global South Summit**: a contemporary multilateral platform India
- ☐ Sikri frames the core strategic choice as whether "India want[s] to be
- ☐ India's simultaneous deepening of ties with the US (technology, defence
- ☐ **PYQ mapping**: no GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers
- ☐ Panchsheel (1954) comprises five principles of peaceful coexistence between
- ☐ Nehru's non-alignment formulation had three elements: no military alliance
- ☐ Non-alignment is described by Bipan Chandra as "an approach, a framework, a
- ☐ Tharoor's "multi-alignment" explicitly includes simultaneous engagement with
- ☐ The third Voice of Global South Summit was convened virtually on 17 August
- ☐ MAHASAGAR ("Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across

MAINS ANGLE

These are model content points; arrange them into paragraphs rather than reproducing a list.

STUDY LINK

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy -> 10-mark answer

HIGH**Solved 15-Mark Practice**

GS-II
International
Relations

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analyse Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**1. Concept**

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ **Panchsheel (1954)**: historical normative reference for peaceful
- ☐ **Non-alignment / NAM**: historical institutional expression of the refusal
- ☐ **SAGAR and its stated extension MAHASAGAR**: ☐ SAGAR ("Security and Growth
- ☐ **Act East / Neighbourhood First**: contemporary policy doctrines that
- ☐ **Development partnership model**: lines of credit, capacity building and
- ☐ **Voice of Global South Summit**: a contemporary multilateral platform India
- ☐ Sikri frames the core strategic choice as whether "India want[s] to be
- ☐ India's simultaneous deepening of ties with the US (technology, defence
- ☐ **PYQ mapping**: no GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers
- ☐ Panchsheel (1954) comprises five principles of peaceful coexistence between
- ☐ Nehru's non-alignment formulation had three elements: no military alliance
- ☐ Non-alignment is described by Bipan Chandra as "an approach, a framework, a
- ☐ Tharoor's "multi-alignment" explicitly includes simultaneous engagement with
- ☐ The third Voice of Global South Summit was convened virtually on 17 August
- ☐ MAHASAGAR ("Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across

MAINS ANGLE

These are model content points; arrange them into paragraphs rather than reproducing a list.

STUDY LINK

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy -> 15-mark answer

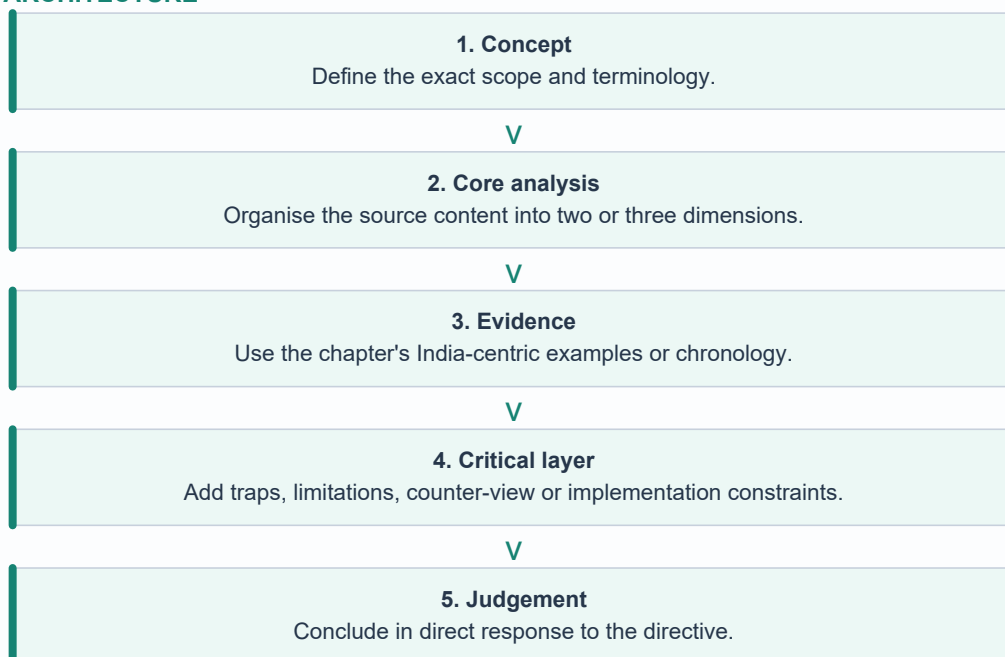
HIGH

Solved 20-Mark Practice

GS-II
International
Relations

INTRO & ORIGIN

Critically examine Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**STATIC THEORY**

- ☐ **Panchsheel (1954)**: historical normative reference for peaceful
- ☐ **Non-alignment / NAM**: historical institutional expression of the refusal
- ☐ **SAGAR and its stated extension MAHASAGAR**: ☐ SAGAR ("Security and Growth
- ☐ **Act East / Neighbourhood First**: contemporary policy doctrines that
- ☐ **Development partnership model**: lines of credit, capacity building and
- ☐ **Voice of Global South Summit**: a contemporary multilateral platform India
- ☐ Sikri frames the core strategic choice as whether "India want[s] to be
- ☐ India's simultaneous deepening of ties with the US (technology, defence
- ☐ **PYQ mapping**: no GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers
- ☐ Panchsheel (1954) comprises five principles of peaceful coexistence between
- ☐ Nehru's non-alignment formulation had three elements: no military alliance
- ☐ Non-alignment is described by Bipan Chandra as "an approach, a framework, a
- ☐ Tharoor's "multi-alignment" explicitly includes simultaneous engagement with
- ☐ The third Voice of Global South Summit was convened virtually on 17 August
- ☐ MAHASAGAR ("Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across

MAINS ANGLE

These are model content points; arrange them into paragraphs rather than reproducing a list.

STUDY LINK

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic
Autonomy -> 20-mark answer

HIGH

Workbook Rapid Revision

GS-II
International
Relations

INTRO & ORIGIN

Final revision is placed after teaching and solved practice.

TOPIC RECALL MAP

Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy

V

Definition ☐ Panchsheel (1954): historical normative reference for peaceful	Mechanism ☐ Non-alignment / NAM: historical institutional expression of the refusal
Application ☐ SAGAR and its stated extension MAHASAGAR: ☐ SAGAR ("Security and Growth	Evaluation ☐ Act East / Neighbourhood First: contemporary policy doctrines that

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ **Panchsheel (1954):** historical normative reference for peaceful
- ☐ **Non-alignment / NAM:** historical institutional expression of the refusal
- ☐ **SAGAR and its stated extension MAHASAGAR:** ☐ SAGAR ("Security and Growth
- ☐ **Act East / Neighbourhood First:** contemporary policy doctrines that
- ☐ **Development partnership model:** lines of credit, capacity building and
- ☐ **Voice of Global South Summit:** a contemporary multilateral platform India
- ☐ Sikri frames the core strategic choice as whether "India want[s] to be
- ☐ India's simultaneous deepening of ties with the US (technology, defence
- ☐ **PYQ mapping:** no GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers
- ☐ Panchsheel (1954) comprises five principles of peaceful coexistence between
- ☐ Nehru's non-alignment formulation had three elements: no military alliance
- ☐ Non-alignment is described by Bipan Chandra as "an approach, a framework, a

MEMORY HOOK

Meaning -> mechanism -> evidence -> limitation -> judgement

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. □ Tharoor's "multi-alignment" explicitly includes simultaneous engagement with
2. □ The third Voice of Global South Summit was convened virtually on 17 August
3. □ MAHASAGAR ("Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across
4. □ □ Strategic autonomy is not neutrality or non-alignment "on every issue at
5. □ The third **Voice of Global South Summit** was held virtually on
6. □ **MAHASAGAR (12 March 2025, Port Louis)** is the most recent dated doctrinal

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Panchsheel and non-alignment are the same concept.

CORRECT: Panchsheel is a set of

WRONG: MAHASAGAR replaced or superseded SAGAR.

CORRECT: The 12 March 2025 announcement

WRONG: Hedging means India avoids taking any position.

CORRECT: Hedging means actively

MAINS ANGLE

Use Foreign-Policy Foundations and Strategic Autonomy as an argument, not as an unstructured list of facts.

STUDY LINK

International Relations -> Foreign-Policy
Foundations and Strategic Autonomy

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI